decent product or excel in any way. The men and women on the Harley Davidson line had a fervor and pride that was uplifting and contagious.

"That's not a factory," I told someone after the visit, "that's a religion."

What I saw at the motorcycle plant and the lumber mill were just samples of a quiet revolution that was going on all over the country.

Few industries complained as much to me or to Congress as our textile industry, which demanded restrictive trade barriers so that it wouldn't have to face such stiff competition from foreign manufacturers. We wouldn't give it the concessions. As a result, the American textile industry undertook its first comprehensive modernization program in decades: Companies closed obsolete plants, built more efficient ones, and installed millions of dollars' worth of modern computer-controlled spinning, weaving, and other equipment that drastically cut production costs and increased productivity for each employee by an average of more than twenty-five percent. Although the demand for unskilled workers in the textile industry declined, there was an upsurge in higher-paying jobs for workers who were given more demanding, more interesting, more responsible, more productive work.

In different ways, much of American industry underwent a similar transformation during the 1980s. Faced with new competition and responding to forces in the free market, our companies went out and made better products and became more efficient at doing it, a transformation borne out by statistics: Between 1982 and 1987, the productivity of American industry increased at an annual rate of more than 4.2 percent, more than one and one-half times the average for the postwar period, while the productivity of individual workers grew by an average of 1.8 percent a year, fifty